CONDITION RATING SYSTEM · EXECUTIVE PRESENTATION

Modernizing the Condition Rating System

A proposal to replace the current numeric grading scale with an intuitive, word-based system that builds customer confidence at every touchpoint.

PRESENTED TO
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PRESENTERS
Isaac Mittelman · Director, Used Dept.
Jerel Smith · Sr. PM, Used Web

PERIOD
Q1 2026

THE PROBLEM

Our current scale creates friction

1 Numeric abstraction

What's the real difference between an 8+ and a 9? Customers can't intuit quality from an abstract number — they have to look it up.

2 Scale fragmentation

Sell Used uses a 1–5 scale. The buy side uses 7–10. These systems are completely disconnected, confusing sellers who become buyers.

3 Hidden condition definitions

In-depth descriptions do not exist inline. Customers must click a (?) link to launch a drawer — not visible at the moment of decision.

4 Expectation misalignment

Survey data shows buyers sometimes feel received condition falls short of the rating — pointing to evaluation inconsistency and unclear standards.

CURRENT BUY SCALE

10	9+	9	8+	8	7	Open Box	Demo

CURRENT SELL SCALE

1	2	3	4	5

Two separate, incompatible scales. Sellers who become buyers encounter a completely different system — flagged directly in Medallia survey responses.

INDUSTRY STANDARD

MPB · KEH · Amazon · Sweetwater all use **plain-language, word-based scales** that customers understand without explanation.

CUSTOMER VOICE

The data backs up the experience

B&H Photo's condition rating system is second to none. I can trust your ratings and have bought used from you with confidence for years.

Trust ✓ NPS 10 · OSAT 5

The pages for used items aren't very descriptive. The condition rating is nice, but I feel like a visual scale with quick descriptions would be more appealing.

Clarity Gap Opportunity

I wish you had a description of your ranges of quality. I chatted with someone to get the explanations of each level, but having it on the same page as the form would have been a better experience.

Needs Inline Descriptions NPS 10 · OSAT 5

One of my lenses was not online. When I talked to a buyer on the phone he used a different condition scale than online. When the item was received I was told the quote was lower. Feels a little scammy.

Scale Inconsistency NPS 2 · OSAT 2

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

The industry has moved — we haven't

RETAILER	SCALE TYPE	TIERS	KEY DIFFERENTIATOR
B&H Photo	Numeric	7 · 8 · 8+ · 9 · 9+ · 10 · Open Box · Demo	8 tiers, 2 scales — customer must decode
MPB	Word-based	Like New · Excellent · Good · Fair	Visual condition bars + per-item photos
KEH Camera	Word-based	Like New · Excellent · Very Good · Good · Fair · Bargain	Video call evaluation for high-value items
Amazon	Word-based	New · Like New · Very Good · Good · Acceptable	Consumer-friendly, immediate comprehension
Sweetwater	Word-based	Excellent · Very Good · Good · Fair · Poor	Each item photographed; condition notes per listing
Adorama	Word-based	Mint · Excellent Plus · Excellent · Average · Well Used · Heavy Use	Consumer-friendly, immediate comprehension

CURRENT STATE

The existing scale

How items are graded and displayed today — per the B&H Used Equipment Rating System

OB	Open Box — Like new condition, includes limited 1-year B&H warranty	Special category
Demo	Never owned — used for demonstration purposes only	Special category
10	Preowned equipment that looks good as new; no signs of wear	Numeric
9+	Preowned equipment that shows little to no signs of wear	10 vs 9+ — ambiguous
9	Very good condition; may have minor signs of use or surface marks	Numeric
8+	Shows moderate wear, scuffing or marks to finish	9 vs 8+ — ambiguous
8	Well used — may exhibit dings or noticeable marks to finish	Numeric
7	Shows considerable wear and above-average signs of use	Lowest tier — hidden

PROPOSED NEW SCALE

Five tiers. Plain language. Instant clarity.

Cosmetic ratings only — all items tested and verified fully functional. Developed with evaluator consensus across the Used operations team.

Excellent

Like-new, no visible signs of wear.

Pristine, like new. No visible signs of wear: scuffing or handling marks on any surface. Finish is perfect. Fully functional.

Very Good

Gently used, minimal signs of wear.

Shows light cosmetic wear. May have minimal scratches or scuffing. Overall gently used condition, clean finish. Fully functional.

Good

Shows moderate wear consistent with regular use.

Moderate wear including scratches, scuffs, or possible minor brassing. Fully functional with no performance issues.

Fair

Well used with visible cosmetic flaws, scuffs, and marks.

Shows obvious cosmetic wear: significant scuffs, noticeable scratches, possible brassing. Well used. Fully functional.

Rough

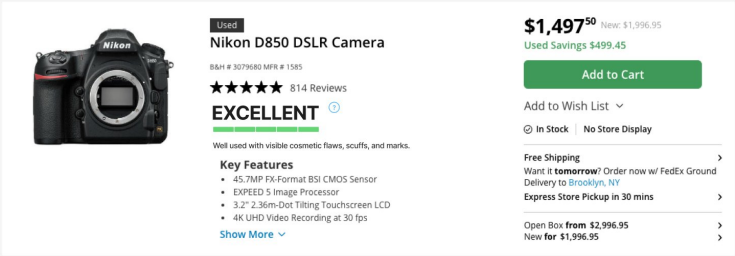
Shows considerable wear, finishing loss, and hard use.

Excessive wear: significant paint and finish loss, exposed metal, deep scratches, possible dents. Fully functional.

Condition at every step of the journey

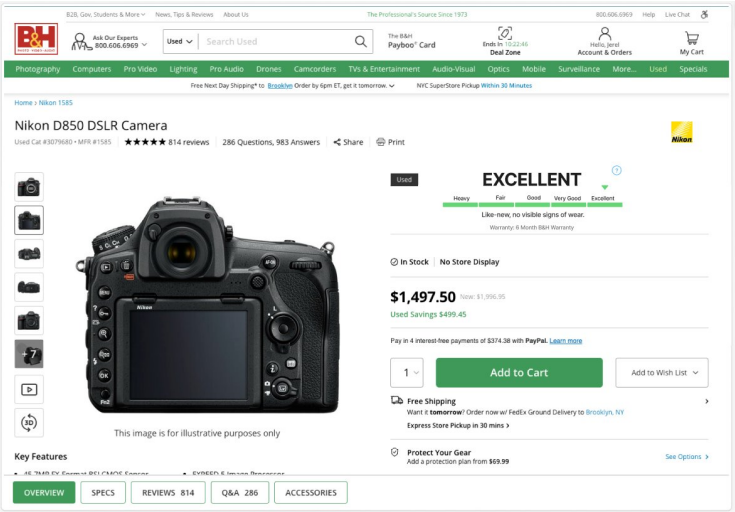
PRODUCT LISTING PAGE (PLP)

Inline card



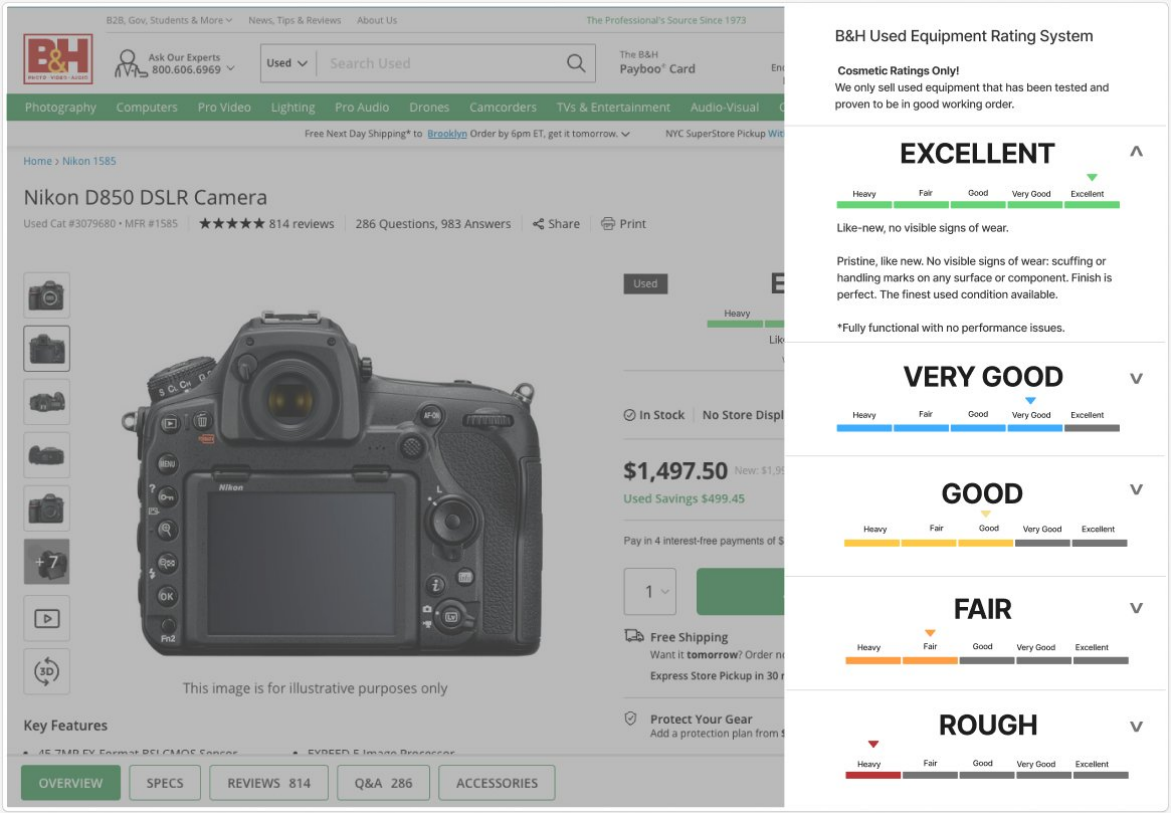
PRODUCT DETAIL PAGE (PDP)

Near add-to-cart



CONDITION DRAWER — (?) MODAL

Defaults to current product grade



IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

Path to launch — targeting H1 2026

Q1 2026

Design & Alignment
In Progress

- COO Presentation
- Scale Finalized w/ Evaluators
- UX Mockups (John)
- Tech Scoping w/ Yoshi Kind

Q2 2026

Development & Internal Rollout
Next Up

- Back-end Mapping (Old → New)
- Evaluator Training
- PLP + PDP Component Build
- Drawer Modal Update
- QA & Regression

Q2 / Q3

Customer-Facing Launch
Target: June

- Go-Live: New Scale on PLP + PDP
- Sell Used Scale Alignment
- Customer-Facing Comms
- Analytics Tagging

H2 2026

Optimization & Expansion
H2 Planning

- Used Product Photography (Ortery)
- PDP Condition Grouping (KEH-style)
- Used Web Metrics Dashboard
- CSAT Tracking per Tier

Approval to Move Forward

We're asking for alignment on the proposed scale and authorization to begin development.
The scale has been vetted by the Used operations team and designed in response to direct customer feedback.

✓ Scale Approved by Evaluators

Tech Scoping: Yoshi Kind

UX Owner: John (Used)

Target Launch: June 2026

DIRECTOR, USED DEPT.
Isaac Mittelman

SR. PM, USED WEB
Jerel Smith